

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET E — CASE STUDY & SOURCE-BASED SCENARIOS****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-E-06

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET E - Case Study & Source-Based Scenarios):

1. The question paper comprises **5 In-Depth Case Studies & Source Scenarios** with **5 MCQs each (Total: 25 Questions, 1 Mark each)**.
2. Read each source passage, historical inscription, geographic case, and economic scenario carefully before answering the corresponding questions.
3. Each question has 4 options with a single correct answer.
4. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
5. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

CASE STUDY 1: ELECTORAL MANIPULATION VS FREE CONTEST: MEXICO UNDER THE PRI (1930–2000)

Between 1930 and 2000, Mexico held national presidential elections every six years without military interruption. On paper, the country maintained a functioning constitutional republic with multi-party competition. Yet, in reality, every single election was won by the Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI). Opposition parties contested regularly, but the playing field was structurally rigged. Civil servants and government employees were forced to attend PRI campaign rallies. Primary school teachers were instructed to coerce parents of school children into voting for PRI candidates. National media, television channels, and newspapers heavily favored the ruling party while ignoring or smearing opposition speeches. Furthermore, in the final hours before polling, the government frequently shifted polling booth locations to remote areas without prior notice, disorienting voters. The PRI spent astronomical sums of state public money to secure its candidates' victories. While elections occurred with procedural regularity, the political system failed the fundamental democratic test: elections were neither free nor fair, offering citizens no genuine opportunity to unseat the ruling regime.

Q.1 Why could Mexico between 1930 and 2000 NOT be classified as a genuine democracy, despite holding regular multi-party elections?

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| (A) The country had zero political parties and banned all voting booths | (B) Elections were unfairly manipulated by the ruling PRI using state machinery, coerced employees, biased media, and shifted polling booths |
| (C) The Mexican president was appointed by the Pope in Rome | (D) The country had no written constitution or courts |

Q.2 What democratic feature is violated when public sector employees and teachers are compelled to campaign for the ruling party?

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| (A) The rule of law and political neutrality of state civil servants | (B) The right of the government to tax citizens |
| (C) The right to declare war against foreign countries | (D) The freedom to travel abroad |

Q.3 How did shifting polling booth locations at the last minute benefit the ruling PRI in Mexico?

- (A) It helped voters find the booths faster (B) It created confusion among voters and suppressed opposition turnout in targeted neighborhoods
- (C) It allowed voting to continue for twelve consecutive weeks (D) It decreased election costs for all political parties

Q.4 What essential condition must be met for an election to be considered 'free and fair'?

- (A) The ruling party must always win 100% of the votes (B) Opposition parties must have an equal, genuine opportunity to campaign, access media, and realistically unseat the incumbent rulers
- (C) Only millionaires must be allowed to vote (D) Voting must be conducted without any ballots or machines

Q.5 Which year finally marked the end of the PRI's seven-decade electoral monopoly in Mexico?

- (A) 1950 (B) 2000 (with the election of Vicente Fox)
- (C) 1910 (D) 2026

CASE STUDY 2: MILITARY OVERTHROW & SUBVERSION OF DEMOCRACY: PAKISTAN UNDER GENERAL MUSHARRAF

In October 1999, General Pervez Musharraf led a military coup d'état in Pakistan, overthrowing the democratically elected government of Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif. Musharraf designated himself the 'Chief Executive' and later assumed the presidency. In 2002, he conducted a national referendum granting himself a five-year presidential extension. Pakistani human rights organizations, independent jurists, and opposition parties condemned the referendum as heavily rigged and fraudulent. In August 2002, Musharraf issued the 'Legal Framework Order' (LFO), unilaterally amending the Constitution of Pakistan. Under the LFO, the military President was granted sweeping powers to dismiss the National Assembly and provincial legislatures at will. The work of the civilian cabinet was subordinated to a military-dominated National Security Council. Although parliamentary elections were subsequently held and elected ministers met in Islamabad, sovereign decision-making power rested entirely with military generals and President Musharraf, failing the cardinal test of democracy: sovereign authority must rest with elected representatives.

Q.6 Why could Pakistan under General Musharraf after 2002 NOT be called a genuine democracy, even though an elected parliament existed?

- (A) Pakistan had never held any elections in its entire history (B) Real executive power resided with military generals and an unelected military President who could dismiss parliament at will
- (C) The parliament was composed exclusively of foreign diplomats (D) The country had abolished all written laws and courts

Q.7 What power was granted to the President under the controversial Legal Framework Order (LFO) of 2002 in Pakistan?

- (A) The power to unilaterally dismiss national and provincial elected assemblies (B) The power to eliminate the Pakistani military entirely
- (C) The power to make university education free for all citizens (D) The power to resign from office immediately

Q.8 What body was established under the LFO to supervise the work of civilian ministers?

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| (A) The United Nations General Assembly | (B) A military-dominated National Security Council |
| (C) The Supreme Court of Canada | (D) An international committee of university professors |

Q.9 What fundamental principle of democracy was undermined by Musharraf's 2002 referendum and Legal Framework Order?

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| (A) The principle that final decision-making power must rest with those elected by the citizens | (B) The principle that only army officers should govern nations |
| (C) The principle that taxes must be collected every month | (D) The principle of having a single official national sport |

Q.10 How does a military dictatorship fundamentally differ from a constitutional democracy?

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| (A) In a military dictatorship, rulers seize power by force and are not accountable to citizens through free regular elections | (B) In a democracy, citizens are never allowed to criticize government policies |
| (C) In a military dictatorship, judges have absolute authority over soldiers | (D) There is no difference whatsoever between the two systems |

CASE STUDY 3: POLITICAL EQUALITY & THE STRUGGLE FOR 'ONE PERSON, ONE VOTE, ONE VALUE'

Democracy is fundamentally anchored in the principle of political equality. In a genuine democracy, each adult citizen must have one vote, and each vote must carry equal weight ('one person, one vote, one value'). Throughout global history, however, this principle has faced structural resistance and discrimination. In Saudi Arabia, women were completely denied the right to vote until municipal elections in 2015. In Estonia, citizenship and language laws enacted after the collapse of the Soviet Union made it exceptionally difficult for the ethnic Russian minority (comprising over 25% of the population) to acquire citizenship and participate in national elections. In the Pacific island nation of Fiji, the post-coup electoral system was designed so that the vote of an indigenous Fijian carried significantly more mathematical weight than the vote of an Indo-Fijian citizen. Such weighted voting schemes violate the core egalitarian principle of democratic citizenship, treating citizens as unequal based on gender, ethnicity, or linguistic identity.

Q.11 What does the fundamental democratic principle of 'one person, one vote, one value' mean?

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| (A) Every citizen must pay a cash fine each time they cast a ballot | (B) Every adult citizen must possess exactly one vote, and every vote must carry identical mathematical and moral weight |
| (C) Only property owners should have their votes counted at double value | (D) Wealthier citizens should be given ten votes each |

Q.12 How did Fiji's pre-reform electoral system violate the democratic principle of equal voting value?

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| (A) It banned everyone under 80 years of age from voting | (B) It assigned greater mathematical weight to the vote of an indigenous Fijian compared to that of an Indo-Fijian |
| (C) It allowed only foreign tourists to participate in elections | (D) It decided election winners through wrestling matches |

Q.13 What obstacle did the ethnic Russian minority face in Estonia's political system after 1991?

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| (A) They were forced to join the Estonian army against their will | (B) Strict language and citizenship legislation made it difficult for them to acquire citizenship and voting rights |
| (C) They were prohibited from speaking Russian in their own private homes | (D) They were given five votes each in every parliamentary election |

Q.14 Until the year 2015, which large demographic group was entirely excluded from exercising the right to vote in Saudi Arabia?

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| (A) All men over 50 years of age | (B) Women |
| (C) University professors | (D) Physicians and medical doctors |

Q.15 Why is political equality essential for the preservation of human dignity in a democracy?

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| (A) It ensures that everyone has the exact same bank balance and income | (B) It affirms that every citizen, rich or poor, high-born or low-born, shares equal moral sovereignty in electing the government |
| (C) It allows ruling politicians to rule for life without elections | (D) It eliminates the need for police and courts |

CASE STUDY 4: DEMOCRATIC ACCOUNTABILITY & FAMINE PREVENTION: AMARTYA SEN'S THESIS

Nobel laureate economist Amartya Sen conducted groundbreaking comparative research analyzing the relationship between political democracy and famine prevention. Between 1958 and 1961, China suffered the worst recorded famine in human history, known as the Great Chinese Famine during the 'Great Leap Forward', resulting in an estimated 30 million deaths. During the exact same historical era, newly independent India faced comparable agricultural droughts and food grain deficits, yet India never experienced a mass famine of remotely similar scale. Sen explained this disparity through democratic institutional accountability: in China, the totalitarian Communist regime had banned all opposition political parties, censored the press, and silenced independent whistleblowers. Local officials, terrified of punishment, sent falsified, exaggerated crop yield reports to Beijing, and top leaders remained blind to mass starvation. In contrast, democratic India possessed an independent press that immediately reported localized grain shortages, vocal opposition parties that fiercely criticized government neglect in parliament, and ruling politicians who faced swift electoral defeat if they failed to organize emergency food relief. As Sen famously observed: 'No substantial famine has ever occurred in any independent and democratic country with a relatively free press.'

Q.16 According to economist Amartya Sen, why did democratic India avoid mass famines while non-democratic China suffered 30 million famine deaths in 1958–1961?

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| (A) India was ten times wealthier and had more tractors than China | (B) India's free press, vocal opposition parties, and competitive elections forced the government to act swiftly on food shortages to avoid electoral defeat |
| (C) China had zero farmland and could only grow bamboo | (D) India imported all of its food grains from outer space |

Q.17 What institutional failure in totalitarian China exacerbated the catastrophic scale of the 1958–1961 famine?

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| (A) Having too many independent investigative newspapers | (B) The absence of opposition parties and free press, which led local cadres to submit falsified reports while leaders ignored starvation |
| (C) Allowing citizens to protest freely outside the capital | (D) Conducting weekly democratic referendums on farm policy |

Q.18 What crucial role does an independent free press play in sustaining a healthy democracy?

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| (A) Publishing only state-approved praises of the Prime Minister | (B) Serving as a public watchdog that investigates policy failures, exposes corruption, and alerts authorities to public grievances |
| (C) Running commercial advertisements without reporting any news | (D) Encouraging citizens to stop voting in elections |

Q.19 Sen's comparative study demonstrates that the primary advantage of democracy over autocracy is:

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| (A) Democracy makes decisions in ten seconds without thinking | (B) Democratic governments are far more accountable and responsive to the vital life-and-death needs of their citizens |
| (C) Democracies never experience natural disasters like droughts | (D) Democratic leaders are immune from public criticism |

Q.20 What can democratic citizens do when an elected government fails to respond adequately to public crises?

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| (A) Nothing, because elected governments rule permanently for life | (B) Express grievances through protests, media debates, and vote the governing party out of power in the next election |
| (C) Surrender all citizenship rights to the military | (D) Ask foreign armies to invade the country |

CASE STUDY 5: CONSTITUTIONAL LIMITS ON POWER & RULE OF LAW: ZIMBABWE UNDER ROBERT MUGABE

Zimbabwe gained national independence from white minority rule in 1980. The country was subsequently led by Robert Mugabe, a charismatic leader of the freedom struggle, and his party ZANU-PF. Zimbabwe held regular presidential and parliamentary elections, and Mugabe consistently won reelection. Yet, political analysts agree that Zimbabwe ceased to function as a genuine constitutional democracy. Over three decades, President Mugabe amended the national constitution repeatedly to expand executive presidential powers and diminish executive accountability. Opposition party workers from the Movement for Democratic Change (MDC) were systematically harassed, beaten, and their meetings violently disrupted. The government controlled state television and radio networks, broadcasting exclusively ruling-party propaganda, while independent journalists were jailed under draconian defamation laws. Crucially, Mugabe's regime openly defied court rulings issued by independent judges and pressured judges to resign. Zimbabwe proved that popular electoral approval alone does not guarantee democracy; a true democracy requires institutional rule of law, separation of powers, and constitutional respect for basic civil rights.

Q.21 Why did regular election victories by President Robert Mugabe in Zimbabwe fail to prove the existence of a true democracy?

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| (A) Mugabe was an artificial computer hologram | (B) Popular mandate was accompanied by suppression of opposition, state control of media, harassment of dissidents, and defiance of court orders |
| (C) Zimbabwe had zero citizens living inside its borders | (D) Elections were conducted exclusively in foreign countries |

Q.22 What democratic institution did the Mugabe government systematically undermine by ignoring its rulings?

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| (A) The state football association | (B) The independent judiciary and the rule of law |
| (C) The national lottery board | (D) The private hotel association |

Q.23 How does constitutional democracy protect against the 'tyranny of the majority'?

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| (A) By giving the majority complete license to crush all minorities | (B) By establishing Fundamental Rights and constitutional boundaries that no elected majority can arbitrarily violate |
| (C) By canceling all elections forever | (D) By letting the army rule the country |

Q.24 What key distinction exists between a 'popular' government and a 'democratic' government?

- (A) A popular government can become autocratic if it dismantles institutional checks, whereas a democratic government must abide by constitutional rule of law
- (B) There is zero difference; every popular ruler is automatically a saint
- (C) Popular governments never collect taxes
- (D) Democratic governments are always run by kings

Q.25 In a healthy constitutional democracy, what must happen after an election is concluded?

- (A) All defeated opposition party leaders must be immediately imprisoned
- (B) The ruling party must govern within constitutional limits, respecting the rights of the opposition to criticize and function freely
- (C) The constitution must be burned and rewritten from scratch every week
- (D) All independent news channels must be permanently shut down

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET E)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & CASE STUDY ANALYTICAL EXPLANATIONS (SET E)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(B)	A genuine democracy requires free and fair elections where ruling parties can realistically lose; the PRI monopolized state resources to rig outcomes.
Q.2	(A)	Coercing government employees weaponizes state machinery against the opposition, violating the democratic requirement for an impartial playing field.
Q.3	(B)	Moving booths disoriented voters, making it impossible for many citizens to cast their ballots, thus suppressing opposition votes.
Q.4	(B)	Free and fair elections require a level playing field where incumbents can be defeated if the popular electorate chooses.
Q.5	(B)	In the historic 2000 presidential election, Vicente Fox of the opposition National Action Party (PAN) won, ending 71 years of PRI rule.
Q.6	(B)	In a democracy, the ultimate decision-making power must vest in representatives elected by the people, not in military officers.
Q.7	(A)	The LFO amended the constitution to allow the military president to dissolve elected parliaments and subordinate civilian rule to the army.
Q.8	(B)	The National Security Council, dominated by military generals, supervised and vetoed civilian government decisions.
Q.9	(A)	Popular sovereignty requires that ultimate sovereign decisions must be made by elected representatives accountable to the electorate.
Q.10	(A)	Military regimes rely on armed force and coercion, lacking popular legitimacy, electoral accountability, and institutional checks.
Q.11	(B)	Democratic equality requires universal adult suffrage where every vote has equal value regardless of wealth, gender, or social origin.
Q.12	(B)	Weighting indigenous Fijian votes higher than Indo-Fijian votes violated the democratic canon that all citizen votes must have identical value.
Q.13	(B)	Stringent linguistic citizenship requirements disenfranchised a large proportion of Estonia's Russian-speaking minority.
Q.14	(B)	Saudi women were barred from voting until historic municipal elections in 2015, violating universal adult suffrage.
Q.15	(B)	Equal voting power affirms that all human beings hold equal moral dignity and equal voice in sovereign governance.
Q.16	(B)	Democratic transparency, critical media, and electoral accountability pressure democratic leaders into responsive disaster mitigation.
Q.17	(B)	Without free speech or political competition, totalitarian leadership received falsified reports and lacked incentive to admit errors.
Q.18	(B)	A free press acts as an independent watchdog, uncovering government shortcomings and providing truthful data to the public.
Q.19	(B)	Democracies institutionalize responsive governance because political survival depends directly on public welfare and citizen satisfaction.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.20	(B)	Democracies empower citizens with regular electoral mechanisms and civil liberties to peacefully replace unresponsive administrations.
Q.21	(B)	Elections alone do not equal democracy; constitutional democracy requires civil liberties, an independent judiciary, and fair contestation.
Q.22	(B)	Disobeying court judgments and intimidating judges destroys the rule of law and eliminates constitutional checks on executive power.
Q.23	(B)	Constitutionalism sets inviolable legal protections for minorities that prevent majorities from exercising absolute, arbitrary power.
Q.24	(A)	Popularity can easily descend into demagoguery and autocracy if institutional checks, free press, and judicial autonomy are dismantled.
Q.25	(B)	Electoral victors must respect constitutional norms, protect minority rights, and preserve full democratic space for opposition critique.